



Delaware County Council Meeting May 26th, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4QeX9NmYOjk
Publication Date	2026-05-27T05:16:28Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Council Municipal Meeting Report

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Mr. Hughes called the meeting to order, opening with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:22](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Hughes (Presiding Officer), Mr. Langan, Mr. Swet (or Whitehead), Mr. Mogle (or Smoggle), Mr. Bookout, Ms. Piper, Mr. Can (or Kans / Kz).
 - **Absent:** None noted in the roll call.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:22](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - **February 24, 2024 Council Minutes:** Motion by Eugene, second by Brad to untable [00:12:46](#). Motion by Eugene, second by Jessica to amend the minutes to reflect that prior minutes from December 16, January 6, and January 27 were simply approved rather than untabled [00:14:05](#). Approved as amended by roll call vote.
 - **March 31, 2024 Council Minutes:** Removed from the table and approved by roll call vote [00:15:21](#) (Mr. Can abstained).

- **April 28, 2024 Council Minutes:** Motion by Eugene, second by Jessica to table the minutes for further review regarding how roll calls were recorded without vote totals [00:16:21](#). Approved by roll call vote to table.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:05:52 Additional Appropriation: Courts (Probation Officers)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jeff Hanser, Chief Probation Officer (speaking on behalf of Judge Calhoun and the courts).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Seeking an additional appropriation of \$35,253.28 from County General to properly fund specific probation officer lines for the 2026 calendar year. Hanser explained that due to an inadvertent oversight during 2025 budget hearings compounded by the recent departure of the court administrator certain probation officer line items were inadequately funded when officers hit years-of-service anniversary milestones that trigger pay cohort increases. He also noted that Indiana has frozen probation officer salaries for 2027 with no cost-of-living allowance (COLA) increases. Council members emphasized the need for better written documentation and processes to avoid future budgeting gaps.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously (Roll call vote; all ayes).
- **00:16:51 Transfer & Appropriation: Public Defender's Office**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Shelley Harvey, Office Administrator, Public Defender's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requesting \$3,500 in supplemental public defenders funds (capital outlays) to purchase a storage container to be placed at the justice center near the clerk's storage container. Harvey explained the office currently pays \$193 a month for a commercial storage unit housing files dating back 20+ years. Under state retention schedules, felony and murder files must be retained forever or until the defendant's death. The one-time purchase of a storage container will eliminate ongoing monthly rental fees. Commissioners already granted permission for placement.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call (Passed unanimously).
- **00:23:19 Appropriation: County Highway Department**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carrie, County Highway Department (with Tom).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requesting \$54,983.72 from MVH (Motor Vehicle Highway) machinery funds, representing proceeds from a March 13 highway equipment auction, to put toward purchasing a "MowerMax" American-made

tractor/brush cutter with a 26-foot boom and rotary mulch head. The total cost of the equipment is \$322,402.34, with DCRC supplementing the remaining \$267,418.62. The equipment will be used full-time year-round for clearing brush, fence rows, and ditch lines.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed unanimously).
- **00:29:23 Appropriation: County EMS (Ambulance Replacement Remount)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Ashley Doer, County EMS Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requesting \$109,043 from ambulance replacement funds (capital outlays) to finish paying for an ambulance remount project started in September 2024. The total chassis and remount cost is approximately \$165,846. A new truck of this size would cost roughly \$400,000, making the remount a cost-effective alternative. Delays were attributed to supply chain issues and a fire at the painting facility near the Michigan line.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed unanimously).
- **00:33:54 Appropriation: County EMS (Contractual Services / Unpaid Bills)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Ashley Doer, County EMS Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requesting \$88,000 in capital improvements funds to cover historical unpaid bills and invoices discovered in un-opened mail after the office manager resigned. Director Doer noted he is taking full responsibility, implementing new office management, and utilizing capital improvement funds (which receive \$15,000/month in revenue) to square away outstanding vendor accounts without impacting county general funds.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed unanimously).
- **00:36:16 Major Transfers: County EMS**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Ashley Doer, County EMS Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A major internal transfer totaling zero net change (\$78,000 from capital improvements contractual services reallocated to EMS contractual services, utilities, vehicle repairs, and building repairs) to properly categorize operating expenses.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed unanimously).
- **00:39:04 Major Transfers: County EMS (Medical Supplies)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mike Ashley Doer, County EMS Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A transfer of \$10,000 from capital improvements contractual services to medical supplies (net transfer zero). Director Doer explained that medical supply accounts took a hit due to adopting a new national standard pediatric program ("Hentevi") and obtaining a state pharmacy and DEA license required to handle controlled narcotics directly rather than through hospitals.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed unanimously).
- **00:43:15 Major Transfers: Sheriff's Office to EMS**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nancy Marvin, Sheriff's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of funds (\$7,261.16) for a 2025 repair and maintenance bill originally paid by EMS that was actually a Sheriff's Office expense.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed unanimously).
- **00:44:18 Financial Transfers & Salary Ordinance Amendment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Motion to approve financial transfers and amend the salary ordinance with like reductions.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed unanimously).
- **00:44:38 Back-Filling Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Motion to receive the back-filling report covering two open positions (one in the jail, one in the communications center).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed unanimously).
- **00:45:07 Resolution No. 2026-0001: Ratifying ARP Appropriations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Steven Brand, Delaware County Commissioner.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Resolution ratifying American Rescue Plan (ARP) appropriations for balances as of January 1 for the years 2024, 2025, and 2026. Commissioner Brand noted that State Board of Accounts recommends annual ratification due to evolving federal rules.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed unanimously).
- **00:47:20 Joint Resolution No. 2026-101: Payroll Internal Controls & Segregation of Duties**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Board / Ed (Council Attorney/Staff).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Establishes a three-level payroll control structure (submission, approval, independent review), dual approval requirements, segregation of duties, and self-pay controls to protect public funds. Extensive debate occurred regarding terminology ("prepare" vs. "submit"), department head/elected official approval, and designated proxies.
 - **Amendments:** Amended to change "prepare" to "submit" across relevant clauses, add "or designate" to departmental approvals, and clarify that an individual cannot both submit and approve their own payroll.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Resolution and amendments Approved by Roll Call Vote (Passed unanimously). Will go back to the Commissioners for concurrence on council changes.
 - **00:16:43 / 01:16:43 Joint Resolution No. 2026-100: Financial & Administrative System Modernization ("One-Touch")**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ed / OpenGov Representatives (Samantha Grabac, James Dwire, Brian Brighton).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Resolution authorizing a countywide financial and administrative system modernization initiative ("One-Touch") utilizing OpenGov software to integrate enterprise asset management, permitting and licensing, and performance management. OpenGov presented a pitch highlighting a 40% discount (prorated software cost of \$126,786 for year one, with initial implementation/services of \$80,880.88). Council members discussed contract lengths, 5% annual escalators, implementation timelines, and departmental readiness (Highway, Health, Sheriff).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Joint Resolution 2026-100 adopted by Roll Call Vote (Passed unanimously). A motion to provide a formal "favorable recommendation" for an associated purchase order/statement of work was withdrawn after legal discussion, with the council agreeing to handle funding via standard appropriation requests in subsequent months.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **02:46:42 Rick Yenser** (Newsman/Author): Addressed the board regarding budgeting and spending. He cautioned against potential city income tax increases, urged fiscal restraint ("live within your means"), and questioned whether the OpenGov software features AI assistance and how it benefits the public directly given limited local media coverage.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - **Annual AIC Conference:** Council members discussed registration and hotel bookings through the auditor's office.
 - **Website & IT Updates:** Kyle Johnson is spearheading the county website redesign (slated for summer release). Active directory cleanup is ongoing. Mandatory KnowBe4 IT security training reminders were emphasized by Commissioner Brand; non-compliance may result in disabled network credentials.
 - **Treasurer Update:** Requested to appear at next month's meeting for a status update.

- **2027 Budget Guidance:** Council President discussed upcoming budget constraints driven by high circuit breaker/tax cap losses in Delaware County, advising departments to keep operating and capital requests flat for the upcoming budget cycle. FICA (7.65%) and PERF (11.2%) rates remain unchanged for 2027.
 - **Adjournment:** Motion to adjourn by Jessica, second by Dan. Approved by unanimous voice vote [02:52:36](#).
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